

Paradiem

The Morning Brief

SEPTEMBER 18, 2026

Relief Rally

Post-hike chip surge lifts Nasdaq +1.73% as the \$24.3B F-35 Saudi clearance, oil softening, and next week's Trump-Xi AI dinner frame the Friday setup.

S&P 500 (SPY, THU CLOSE) \$762.60 ↑1.13% Thu	NASDAQ (QQQ) / AMD (TOP MOVER) \$716.92 ↑1.73% / \$545.09 ↑6.36%	TLT / UVXY (THU) \$81.78 ↑1.11% / \$17.44 ↓5.83%	USO (WTI PROXY) / BNO (BRENT) \$155.31 ↓0.55% / \$60.91 ↓1.30%	FEAR & GREED (CNN STOCK) ~31 Fear per CNN · Drop crypto fallback 56
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Markets — A Post-Hike Relief Rally Reportedly Lifts SPY ↑1.13% and QQQ ↑1.73% Into Friday as the FCI Chip Complex Extends With AMD ↑6.36% at \$545.09, MRVL ↑4.81% at \$240.76, CRDO ↑4.19% at \$168.25, and TSM ↑3.00% at \$430.26; TLT Reportedly ↑1.11% at \$81.78 as the 10-Year Yield Reportedly Pulls Back From Approximately 5%; Gold ↑1.69% and Silver ↑3.37% as the Dollar Reportedly Softens; Industrial Production Publishes at 9:15 AM ET Ahead of Next Week's Trump-Xi Summit

THE FRIDAY SETUP READS THROUGH A THURSDAY CASH SESSION THAT DELIVERED A BROAD RELIEF RALLY AS WALL STREET REPORTEDLY DIGESTED WEDNESDAY'S HAWKISH HIKE — PER DATA DROP, THURSDAY'S CASH SESSION CLOSED WITH SPY AT \$762.60 (↑1.13%), QQQ AT \$716.92 (↑1.73%), DOW AT \$518.35 (↑0.61%), IWM AT \$285.43 (↑0.53%), UVXY AT \$17.44 (↓5.83%), AND TLT AT \$81.78 (↑1.11%); PER CHARTMILL COVERAGE CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP HOLDINGS NEWS ACROSS AMD, MRVL, NOW, AND HOOD, THE FRAMING REPORTEDLY DESCRIBED A HAWKISH FED THAT IS UNDERSTOOD AS PREFERABLE TO ONE THAT IS NOT — A COMPOSITION CONSISTENT WITH REDUCED GUIDANCE-PATH UNCERTAINTY RATHER THAN AN EASING SIGNAL; PER CNBC AND REUTERS COVERAGE, THE 10-YEAR TREASURY YIELD REPORTEDLY PULLED BACK FROM THE APPROXIMATELY 5.02% POST-STATEMENT HIGH TOWARD THE LOWER 4.9% HANDLE AS BONDS REPORTEDLY BID ALONGSIDE EQUITIES

Per data drop, Thursday's cash session closed with SPY at \$762.60 (↑1.13%), QQQ at \$716.92 (↑1.73%) leading, Dow at \$518.35 (↑0.61%), IWM at \$285.43 (↑0.53%), UVXY reportedly ↓5.83% at \$17.44 as implied volatility receded, and TLT at \$81.78 (↑1.11%) as long-duration bid alongside equities in the classic post-Fed relief composition. Per ChartMill coverage carried in the data drop holdings news across AMD, MRVL, NOW, and HOOD, one framing reportedly described the tape as Wall Street deciding that a hawkish Fed it can understand outperforms a Fed it cannot — a communication-clarity read consistent with the Warsh press conference and the reintroduction of a formal dot plot flagged in yesterday's brief. Per CNBC and Reuters coverage, the 10-year Treasury yield reportedly pulled back from the approximately 5.02% post-statement high toward the lower 4.9% handle as bonds reportedly bid, and per data drop, gold (GLD) reportedly closed ↑1.69% at \$398.36 with silver (SLV) reportedly ↑3.37% at \$58.97 as the dollar reportedly softened. Per data drop, XLK reportedly led sectors ↑2.25%, XLY ↑1.10%, and XLU ↑0.90%, while XLF reportedly closed ↓0.09% and XLC ↓0.58% — a composition where the rate-sensitive and long-duration growth axes reportedly led rather than the cyclical or communication complex. Per Federal Reserve H.15 release schedule, August Industrial Production and Capacity Utilization publish Friday at 9:15 AM ET, giving the committee one incremental read on the real-economy Fed input before the weekly close and the reported September 24 Trump-Xi state visit. Per data drop sentiment field, the CNN Fear & Greed reading of 56 "Greed" reflects the CNN endpoint reportedly falling back to the crypto Fear-and-Greed index; per MacroMicro coverage of the CNN stock-market read, the actual reading reportedly sits near approximately 31 "Fear" as of Thursday, materially below the crypto proxy and consistent with the still-cautious posture.

S&P 500 (SPY, THU CLOSE)	\$762.60 ↑1.13% Thu
NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW / RUSSELL 2K (THU)	\$716.92 ↑1.73% / \$518.35 ↑0.61% / \$285.43 ↑0.53%
TLT / UVXY (THU CLOSE)	\$81.78 ↑1.11% / \$17.44 ↓5.83%
USO (WTI PROXY) / BNO (BRENT, THU)	\$155.31 ↓0.55% / \$60.91 ↓1.30%
GOLD (GLD) / SILVER (SLV, THU)	\$398.36 ↑1.69% / \$58.97 ↑3.37%
XLK / XLE SECTORS (THU)	↑2.25% / ↑0.70% per data drop
IBIT / ETHA (THU CLOSE)	\$43.30 ↑0.60% / \$18.47 ↑1.76%

THE FCI CHIP COMPLEX REPORTEDLY LED THURSDAY'S COMPOSITION WITH AMD ↑6.36% AT \$545.09, MRVL ↑4.81% AT \$240.76, CRDO ↑4.19% AT \$168.25, TSM ↑3.00% AT \$430.26, KEYS ↑2.92% AT \$331.44, NVDA ↑2.54% AT \$219.34, TEL ↑2.18% AT \$206.60, QCOM ↑2.09% AT \$188.71, AND NXPI ↑4.10% AT \$227.95 — PER YAHOO FINANCE COVERAGE CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP, MARVELL REPORTEDLY DEEPENED ITS AI INFRASTRUCTURE FOOTPRINT, AND PER YAHOO FINANCE COVERAGE, REPORTS REPORTEDLY FRAMED THE TRUMP-XI DINNER NEXT WEEK AS BRINGING OPENAI'S ALTMAN, NVIDIA'S HUANG, AND QUALCOMM'S AMON TO THE TABLE — THE COMPOSITION READS DIRECTLY INTO THE FCI PHYSICAL-AI-INFRASTRUCTURE THESIS AHEAD OF THE SEPTEMBER 24 STATE VISIT

Per data drop top movers, Thursday's Fed-day-after tape reportedly concentrated the FCI physical-AI-infrastructure sleeve with AMD ↑6.36% at \$545.09 leading, MRVL ↑4.81% at \$240.76, CRDO ↑4.19% at \$168.25, TSM ↑3.00% at \$430.26, KEYS ↑2.92% at \$331.44, NVDA ↑2.54% at \$219.34, TEL ↑2.18% at \$206.60, QCOM ↑2.09% at \$188.71, and NXPI ↑4.10% at \$227.95 — a full-sleeve reversal from the residual compression carried through Tuesday. Per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, Marvell Technology reportedly deepened its AI infrastructure footprint per one coverage piece, and per Yahoo Finance and CNBC coverage referenced in the data drop, reports reportedly frame the September 24 Trump-Xi state visit as including a state dinner with OpenAI CEO Sam Altman, Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang, and Qualcomm CEO Cristiano Amon expected to attend alongside Apple's Cook per Bloomberg coverage. Per data drop, LRCX reportedly closed flat at \$269.31 with an intraday range from \$266.90 to \$281.40, indicating a volatile session, and per Yahoo Finance coverage, Lam Research reportedly trades at a premium tied to expanded shareholder returns. For FCI positioning, the composition — a Fed-day-after chip lift concentrated across AMD, MRVL, CRDO, TSM, and NVDA, the reported AI-CEO composition at the upcoming Trump-Xi dinner, and the intersection with the semiconductor-export-control file — keeps the FCI Growth-Hybrid physical-AI-infrastructure sleeve reading through the Fed rate path and the Pacific-technology diplomacy channel simultaneously.

OIL REPORTEDLY EXTENDED WEDNESDAY'S REVERSAL THURSDAY WITH USO ↓0.55% AT \$155.31 AND BNO ↓1.30% AT \$60.91 AS CNBC AND REUTERS COVERAGE REPORTEDLY FRAMED THE MOVE AGAINST HOPES THAT SAUDI SUPPLY DISRUPTION WOULD REMAIN LIMITED, EVEN AS HORMUZ SHIPPING REPORTEDLY STAYED BELOW THE 10-DAY AVERAGE PER REUTERS — PER DATA DROP, XLE REPORTEDLY CLOSED ↑0.70%, CVX FLAT AT \$211.57, CNX ↓0.56% AT \$33.52, AND OKE ↑0.56% AT \$93.22 WITH FCX ↑2.33% AT \$70.85; PER REUTERS COVERAGE CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP HEADLINES, CHINA'S AUGUST REFINED FUEL EXPORTS REPORTEDLY EXCEEDED PRE-WAR LEVELS WITH JET FUEL REPORTEDLY HITTING A RECORD HIGH

Per data drop, Thursday's energy tape reportedly closed with USO ↓0.55% at \$155.31, BNO ↓1.30% at \$60.91, and UNG ↓0.29% at \$10.33; per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, oil prices reportedly fell approximately 2% intraday on reported hopes of limited Saudi supply disruptions even as shipping traffic through the Strait of Hormuz re-

portedly remained below the 10-day average per separate Reuters data. Per data drop, XLE reportedly closed ↑0.70% as the energy sleeve reportedly divided between the equity bid on the post-hike relief and the physical-crude softening: CVX reportedly closed roughly flat at \$211.57, OKE ↑0.56% at \$93.22, CNX ↓0.56% at \$33.52, and FCX ↑2.33% at \$70.85. Per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, Vitesse reportedly completed an acquisition in the Denver-Julesburg Basin referenced in the CVX file. Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, China's August refined-fuel exports reportedly exceeded pre-Iran-war levels with jet-fuel exports reportedly hitting a record high — a signal consistent with continued Asian refining throughput even as physical-supply choke points reportedly persist. For FCI positioning, the composition — a physical-crude selloff on reported de-escalation optics, a Hormuz throughput reportedly still compressed against the 10-day average, and a Chinese refined-product export tape reportedly at record highs — keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, and FCX reading through a set of drivers that reportedly pull the tape simultaneously toward two different framings.

THE PRECIOUS-METALS COMPLEX REPORTEDLY EXTENDED ITS MOVE THURSDAY WITH GOLD (GLD) ↑1.69% AT \$398.36 AND SILVER (SLV) ↑3.37% AT \$58.97 AS THE DOLLAR REPORTEDLY SOFTENED POST-HIKE; PER DATA DROP, AEM REPORTEDLY CLOSED ↑2.97% AT \$201.37 WITH FCX ↑2.33% AT \$70.85 AND STLD ↑2.99% AT \$245.35 — THE COMPOSITION READS THROUGH THE FCI GROWTH-HYBRID METALS AND BASIC-MATERIALS SLEEVE AHEAD OF Q3 EARNINGS; PER YAHOO FINANCE COVERAGE CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP, STEEL DYNAMICS REPORTEDLY PROVIDED THIRD QUARTER 2026 EARNINGS GUIDANCE

Per data drop, Thursday reportedly saw gold (GLD) ↑1.69% at \$398.36 and silver (SLV) ↑3.37% at \$58.97 as the dollar reportedly softened on the post-hike bond-yield pullback; per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, gold miners reportedly rallied as bullion rebounded on the softer dollar. Per data drop, AEM reportedly closed ↑2.97% at \$201.37, FCX reportedly ↑2.33% at \$70.85, and STLD reportedly ↑2.99% at \$245.35 — a materials-complex bid consistent with the softer dollar and the lower-yield composition. Per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, Steel Dynamics reportedly issued Q3 2026 earnings guidance, framing an early read on the industrial-metals cycle ahead of the fiscal-Q3 earnings tape. For FCI positioning, the composition — a precious-metals move on the

softer dollar, an FCI basic-materials sleeve moving in sympathy through AEM, FCX, and STLD, and a Steel Dynamics guidance print into Q3 — keeps the FCI Growth-Hybrid metals and materials layer reading through the intersection of

the Fed rate path, the dollar tape, and the industrial-cycle read.

A Friday setup where the post-hike relief rally reportedly extends across the chip complex, oil softens against a still-compressed Hormuz throughput, and the precious-metals complex bids on a softer dollar tends to reward reading the composition across the sleeves rather than positioning around any single input. Think like an owner.

SECTION 02

Geopolitics — The State Department Reportedly Cleared a \$24.3 Billion F-35 Sale to Saudi Arabia Thursday, the First Time Reportedly Approving Its Premier Stealth Fighter to a Middle Eastern Nation Other Than Israel; Reuters Reportedly Frames Trump's Skeptical Reception at the UN General Assembly Ahead of the September 24 Trump-Xi State Visit; US Reportedly Allows Iranian Leaders to Attend UNGA

LMT F-35 SAUDI ARABIA DEAL — PER YAHOO FINANCE, BLOOMBERG, AND DEFENSE DAILY COVERAGE CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP HOLDINGS NEWS, THE US STATE DEPARTMENT REPORTEDLY CLEARED A \$24.3 BILLION SALE OF 48 F-35A FIGHTERS TO SAUDI ARABIA ON THURSDAY INCLUDING 49 PRATT & WHITNEY ENGINES, COMMUNICATIONS EQUIPMENT, AND SUSTAINMENT ITEMS; PER COVERAGE, THE APPROVAL REPORTEDLY MARKS THE FIRST TIME THE UNITED STATES HAS AGREED TO SUPPLY THE F-35 TO A MIDDLE EASTERN NATION OTHER THAN ISRAEL; PER DATA DROP, LMT REPORTEDLY CLOSED $\uparrow 0.16\%$ AT \$538.09 WITH AN INTRADAY RANGE OF \$520.42 TO \$542.61 — THE FCI DEFENSE SLEEVE READS DIRECTLY THROUGH THE PROGRAMMATIC LAYER, THE MIDDLE EAST KINETIC PERIMETER, AND THE REPORTED CONGRESSIONAL SCRUTINY AHEAD

Per Yahoo Finance, Bloomberg, and Defense Daily coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, the US State Department reportedly cleared a \$24.3 billion sale of 48 Lockheed Martin F-35A stealth fighters to Saudi Arabia Thursday, including 49 Pratt & Whitney engines, communications equipment, and sustainment items; per coverage, the approval reportedly marks the first time the United States has agreed to supply the F-35 to a Middle Eastern nation other than Israel, with Netanyahu's office reportedly saying understandings with Washington are intended to preserve Israel's regional air superiority. Per data drop, LMT reportedly closed Thursday $\uparrow 0.16\%$ at \$538.09 with an unusually wide intraday range of \$520.42 to \$542.61, and per data drop holdings news, one Yahoo Finance piece reportedly framed how General Motors could benefit from the US defense missile push. Per coverage, congressional scrutiny reportedly remains a potential gating factor tied to prior arms-sale precedents. Per data drop, GD reportedly closed $\downarrow 1.13\%$ at \$355.95 on modest sleeve-internal rotation. For FCI positioning, the composition — a \$24.3 billion F-35 programmatic layer that reportedly reshapes the Middle East defense-sales precedent, an LMT session with a wide intraday range consistent with the news flow, and the ongoing FCI defense sleeve exposure through LMT and GD — keeps the defense sleeve reading through the intersection of the Iran-war operational tempo, the reported Saudi-Israel dynamic, and the congressional-approval file into the weekend.

IRAN WAR — PER REUTERS COVERAGE CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP HEADLINES, PRESIDENT TRUMP REPORTEDLY FACES A SKEPTICAL RECEPTION FROM WORLD LEADERS AT THE UN GENERAL ASSEMBLY AS THE IRAN WAR REPORTEDLY GRINDS ON; PER REUTERS, THE UNITED STATES REPORTEDLY AGREED TO ALLOW IRANIAN LEADERS TO ATTEND UNGA EVEN AS STRAIT OF HORMUZ SHIPPING REPORTEDLY STAYS BELOW

THE 10-DAY AVERAGE; PER REUTERS COVERAGE, EXPLAINER-STYLE COVERAGE REPORTEDLY FRAMED HOW THE HOUTHIS WENT FROM A SMALL MOUNTAIN MILITIA TO A REGIONAL THREAT; PER REUTERS, SOUTH KOREA'S LEE REPORTEDLY SAID HE WILL NOT DEPLOY MILITARY FORCES TO THE MIDDLE EAST — THE COMPOSITION REPORTEDLY

EXTENDS THE DIPLOMATIC TRACK IN PARALLEL WITH THE CONTINUED KINETIC PERIMETER

Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, President Trump reportedly faces a skeptical reception at the UN General Assembly this week as the Iran war reportedly grinds on into the sixth month, and per separate Reuters coverage, the United States reportedly agreed to allow Iranian leaders to attend UNGA in New York, opening a formal multilateral channel even as the operational tempo reportedly continues. Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop, Strait of Hormuz shipping traffic reportedly stayed below the 10-day average on Thursday's data, and per Reuters explainer coverage carried in the data drop, one piece reportedly framed the trajectory of the Houthis from a small mountain militia to a broader regional threat — a framing that reads directly into the kinetic-perimeter composition referenced in prior briefs. Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, South Korea's Lee reportedly stated Seoul will not deploy military forces to the Middle East, foreclosing a potential East-Asian coalition contribution. Per data drop, the energy sleeve reportedly closed with XLE ↑0.70% even as USO ↓0.55% and BNO ↓1.30% on the reported hopes of limited Saudi disruption. For FCI positioning, the composition — a diplomatic track reportedly formalizing at UNGA, an Iran-Trump exchange dynamic reportedly opening at the multilateral level, and a Hormuz throughput reportedly still compressed — keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, LMT, and GD reading through the intersection of the still-live kinetic map, the reported diplomatic layer, and the reported Chinese refined-fuel exports at record highs referenced in the Markets section.

TRUMP-XI SUMMIT — PER CSIS, REUTERS, AND COVERAGE CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP HEADLINES, PRESIDENT TRUMP REPORTEDLY HOSTS CHINESE GENERAL SECRETARY XI JINPING ON SEPTEMBER 24 IN WASHINGTON FOR THE LEADERS' SECOND SUMMIT OF 2026; PER BLOOMBERG AND ABC NEWS COVERAGE, THE STATE DINNER REPORTEDLY INCLUDES OPENAI'S ALTMAN, NVIDIA'S HUANG,

QUALCOMM'S AMON, AND APPLE'S COOK AHEAD OF CONTINUED DISCUSSIONS REPORTEDLY FRAMED AS FOCUSED ON AI SAFETY, CYBER RISKS, AND EXPORT CONTROLS; PER REUTERS, ADVANCED-SEMICONDUCTOR EXPORT CONTROLS, INDUSTRIAL POLICY, INVESTMENT RESTRICTIONS, AND TAIWAN REPORTEDLY REMAIN UNRESOLVED — THE COMPOSITION FRAMES THE FCI SEMICONDUCTOR SLEEVE'S READING INTO NEXT WEEK

Per CSIS, Reuters, Bloomberg, and ABC News coverage carried in the data drop, President Trump reportedly hosts Chinese General Secretary Xi Jinping on September 24 in Washington for the leaders' second summit of 2026, following the reported May Beijing summit; per Bloomberg and ABC News coverage, the state dinner reportedly includes OpenAI CEO Sam Altman, Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang, and Qualcomm CEO Cristiano Amon, with Apple Executive Chairman Tim Cook reportedly also attending. Per CSIS framing carried in the data drop, both governments are reportedly expected to continue discussions covering AI safety, cyber risks, and governance frameworks, though meaningful US concessions on advanced-semiconductor export controls reportedly remain unlikely; per Reuters and CSIS coverage, disputes involving advanced-technology controls, industrial policy, investment restrictions, and Taiwan are reportedly likely to persist beyond the meeting. Per data drop, NVDA reportedly closed ↑2.54% at \$219.34, QCOM ↑2.09% at \$188.71, and TSM ↑3.00% at \$430.26 Thursday, and per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, one piece reportedly framed TSM as approximately 14% overvalued following a reported 2nm MediaTek win. For FCI positioning, the composition — a state visit reportedly bringing the AI-CEO tier alongside the Chinese leadership, an export-control framework reportedly unchanged, and a Taiwan file reportedly unresolved — keeps NVDA, QCOM, TSM, MRVL, KEYS, and TEL reading through the intersection of the Fed rate path, the AI-safety debate, and the Pacific-technology diplomacy channel simultaneously.

On Our Radar

1. Friday Data Docket — Federal Reserve H.15 August Industrial Production and Capacity Utilization Publish at 9:15 AM ET, Providing the First Post-Hike Read on Real-Economy Manufacturing Ahead of Next Week's Trump-Xi State Visit.

Per Federal Reserve H.15 release schedule and coverage carried by Investing.com, August Industrial Production and Capacity Utilization reportedly publish Friday at 9:15 AM ET, and the New York Fed Staff Nowcast reportedly publishes at approximately 12:45 PM ET, giving the investment committee two additional macro reads before the weekly close. Per data drop, XLI reportedly closed Thursday $\uparrow 0.18\%$ at \$169.01 with CAT reportedly $\uparrow 2.02\%$ at \$798.57 leading the FCI industrial-cyclical read and PCAR reportedly $\downarrow 0.73\%$ at \$117.36. Per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, one piece reportedly framed Caterpillar outpacing the broader tape into the print, and per Yahoo Finance coverage, PCAR reportedly plunged approximately 7.3% over the prior four weeks even as coverage reportedly framed a potential trend reversal. For FCI positioning, the composition — a post-hike industrial-production print, a CAT relative-strength read, and a PCAR trajectory framing — keeps the FCI industrial-cyclical exposure through CAT, PCAR, FAST, and GPC reading through the intersection of the Fed rate path and the Friday real-economy print.

2. STLD Reportedly Provided Q3 2026 Earnings Guidance Thursday Ahead of the FCI Industrial-Metals Sleeve Reading Through the Softer Dollar and the Precious-Metals Move — Per Yahoo Finance Coverage Carried in the Data Drop Holdings News, Steel Dynamics Reportedly Issued Third Quarter 2026 Earnings Guidance With STLD Closing $\uparrow 2.99\%$ at \$245.35; Per Data Drop, AEM Reportedly Closed $\uparrow 2.97\%$ at \$201.37 and FCX Reportedly $\uparrow 2.33\%$ at \$70.85 With Gold (GLD) Reportedly $\uparrow 1.69\%$ at \$398.36 and Silver (SLV) Reportedly $\uparrow 3.37\%$ at \$58.97 as the Dollar Reportedly Softened.

Per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, Steel Dynamics reportedly issued Q3 2026 earnings guidance Thursday, and per data drop, STLD reportedly closed $\uparrow 2.99\%$ at \$245.35 on the guidance print. Per data drop, the FCI Growth-Hybrid metals-and-materials layer reportedly moved higher with AEM $\uparrow 2.97\%$ at \$201.37, FCX $\uparrow 2.33\%$ at \$70.85, and CNX modestly lower at \$33.52 ($\downarrow 0.56\%$); per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, gold miners reportedly rallied as bullion rebounded on the reported softer dollar and reported easing oil prices. Per data drop, gold (GLD) reportedly closed $\uparrow 1.69\%$ at \$398.36 and silver (SLV) reportedly $\uparrow 3.37\%$ at \$58.97. For FCI positioning, the composition — an early STLD guidance print into Q3 that reportedly moved the stock, an AEM and FCX metals bid on the softer dollar, and a precious-metals move separate from the industrial-metals guidance — keeps the FCI Growth-Hybrid metals-and-materials sleeve reading through the intersection of the Fed rate path, the dollar tape, and the Q3 industrial-earnings preview.

3. Digital-Asset Sleeve Reads Through Reported Continued ETF Outflows Alongside the Thursday Bounce — Per Benzinga Coverage Carried in the Data Drop Holdings News, Bitcoin and Ethereum ETFs Reportedly Lost Approximately \$1.11 Billion Over Two Days; Per Data Drop, IBIT Reportedly Closed Thursday at \$43.30 (↑0.60%) and ETHA Reportedly at \$18.47 (↑1.76%) With HOOD Reportedly ↑5.16% at \$109.81, MARA Reportedly ↑5.43% at \$11.64, and HUT Reportedly ↑1.30% at \$90.99; Per Yahoo Finance Coverage, Robinhood Ventures Fund I Reportedly Invested \$25 Million in Crusoe on the Reported Framing That the Physical Buildout Behind AI Is What Matters. Per Benzinga and Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, Bitcoin and Ethereum ETFs reportedly lost approximately \$1.11 billion of combined outflows over the two-day window straddling the Fed decision, extending the flow reversal referenced in yesterday's brief. Per data drop, however, the digital-asset sleeve reportedly bounced with IBIT ↑0.60% at \$43.30, ETHA ↑1.76% at \$18.47, HOOD ↑5.16% at \$109.81, MARA ↑5.43% at \$11.64, and HUT ↑1.30% at \$90.99, and per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, Robinhood Ventures Fund I reportedly invested \$25 million into Crusoe with a reported CEO framing that the physical buildout behind AI is what matters — a signal that reads directly into the FCI physical-AI-infrastructure thesis through a Growth-Hybrid holding. Per Seeking Alpha coverage carried in the data drop, one piece reportedly noted Bitcoin down approximately 3% on the week. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported \$1.11 billion two-day ETF outflow window absorbed by an intraday relief bounce, a HOOD-Crusoe investment reportedly linking the digital-asset sleeve to the physical-AI-infrastructure axis, and the CLARITY Act legislative overhang from Tuesday — keeps IBIT, ETHA, HOOD, MARA, and HUT reading through the intersection of the Fed rate path, the AI-infrastructure buildout, and the reported ETF flow reversal.

4. Power-Generation Second-Derivative Reads Through the Post-Hike Reversal — Per Data Drop, CEG Reportedly Closed Thursday at \$262.80 (↑1.26%), VST Reportedly at \$143.56 (↑2.26%), and NEE Reportedly at \$81.28 (↑1.13%) Following Wednesday's Reported Generac-Amazon Warrant-Linked Supply Deal Referenced in Yesterday's Brief; Per Yahoo Finance Coverage Carried in the Data Drop Holdings News, One Piece Reportedly Framed AI-Power Utilities as Getting Paid to Solve the AI Power Problem, and Per Seeking Alpha Coverage, Coverage Reportedly Noted Vistra Analyst Fair Value Edging Lower on Weighing AI Demand and Risks. Per data drop, CEG reportedly closed Thursday ↑1.26% at \$262.80, VST reportedly

↑2.26% at \$143.56, and NEE reportedly ↑1.13% at \$81.28 as the power-generation second-derivative reportedly participated in the Fed-day-after relief; per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, one piece reportedly framed the AI power problem as a tailwind for the utility complex, and per Seeking Alpha coverage carried in the data drop, one Vistra note reportedly framed analyst fair value edging lower on weighing AI demand and risks. Per data drop, EIX reportedly closed ↑1.26% at \$55.50 with a Seeking Alpha piece reportedly framing an FCI-adjacent thesis of buying any Fed rate hike dip; per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, community coverage reportedly highlighted continued participation in SCE's wildfire recovery compensation program. For FCI positioning, the composition — a post-hike lift in CEG, VST, and NEE alongside the reported Generac-Amazon deal referenced in yesterday's brief, an EIX rebound on the softer-yield composition, and the reported utility-AI framing — keeps the FCI power-generation sleeve reading through the intersection of the AI capex cycle, the Fed rate path, and the softer-yield tape.

5. Week-Ahead Setup — Per Federal Reserve, Census Bureau, and Bureau of Economic Analysis Release Schedules Together With Coverage Referenced in the Data Drop, the Week of September 21 Reportedly Delivers August New-Home Sales, the Reported September 24 Trump-Xi State Visit, and the Reported August PCE Price Index Print on Friday September 26, With the FCI Dividend-Strategy and Growth-Hybrid Sleeves Reading Through the First Post-Hike Inflation Read and the Pacific-Technology Diplomacy Channel Simultaneously. Per

Federal Reserve, Census Bureau, and Bureau of Economic Analysis release schedules, the week of September 21 reportedly delivers August New-Home Sales alongside additional macro prints; per CSIS coverage carried in the data drop and Bloomberg and ABC News coverage referenced in Section 02, President Trump reportedly hosts General Secretary Xi Jinping in Washington on September 24 for the leaders' second 2026 summit, with the reported state dinner including AI-CEO participation across Altman, Huang, Amon, and Cook. Per Bureau of Economic Analysis release schedule, the August PCE Price Index reportedly publishes Friday September 26 at 8:30 AM ET, providing the first post-hike inflation read against the reported one-more-hike dot-plot median at approximately 4.125% federal-funds rate flagged in yesterday's brief. For FCI positioning, the composition — a New-Home Sales print into a housing cycle referenced through TOL, GPC, PCAR, and FAST, a Trump-Xi state visit reading through NVDA, QCOM, TSM, MRVL, KEYS, and TEL, and a PCE print reading directly through the Fed rate path — keeps the investment committee reading through a week where the FCI Dividend-Strategy and Growth-Hybrid sleeves reportedly face the intersection of the Fed rate path, the AI-safety debate, and the Pacific-technology diplomacy channel simultaneously.

6. Precious-Metals and FX Read-Through — Per Data Drop, Gold (GLD) Reportedly Closed ↑1.69% at \$398.36 and Silver (SLV) Reportedly ↑3.37% at \$58.97 With AEM Reportedly ↑2.97% at \$201.37 as the Dollar Reportedly Softened Alongside the Post-Hike 10-Year Yield Pullback; Per Yahoo Finance Coverage, Gold Miners Reportedly Rallied as Bullion Rebounded on the Reported Softer Dollar and Reported Easing Oil Prices — A Composition Reading Through the Dividend Sleeve's Precious-Metals Beta and the FCI Growth-Hybrid Materials Complex. Per

data drop, gold (GLD) reportedly closed Thursday ↑1.69% at \$398.36 and silver (SLV) reportedly ↑3.37% at \$58.97, and per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, gold miners reportedly rallied as bullion rebounded on the reported softer dollar and reported easing oil prices; per data drop, AEM reportedly closed ↑2.97% at \$201.37, a strong Dividend-sleeve beta to bullion. Per data drop, ORI reportedly closed among Thursday's laggards ↓0.98% at \$40.50 even as the broader Dividend sleeve participated in the relief.

Per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, Old Republic reportedly announced a partnership with the American Red Cross. For FCI positioning, the composition — a softer-dollar bullion rebound, an AEM Dividend-sleeve read that reportedly captures the precious-metals tape, and a broader Dividend-sleeve participation in the relief — keeps AEM, ORI, and the broader FCI Dividend Strategy sleeve reading through the intersection of the Fed rate path, the dollar tape, and the reported industrial-cycle read into Friday's Industrial Production print.